

Teacher's Companion

Turning the Card Library into sequencing, writing, map, vocabulary, and discussion exercises • Ages 8–12

SEQUENCING & CHRONOLOGY • LEGENDS DECK

Timeline of Kings. Hand out the ten King cards and have students lay them in reign order, from the first king to the last; card numbers are the answer key, so cover the corners while working. Extend by shuffling in Hero cards and asking students to place each hero in the age of the king they served, then verify on the Timeline of Kings at epicofkings.com. **Cause and consequence chains.** Give a group three connected cards (for example Jamshid, Zahhak, Kaveh) and ask them to arrange the cards in story order and explain, in one sentence per card, how each event caused the next. **Generations ladder.** Using the Bloodline lines, students build the Sam family ladder (Sam, Zal, Rostam, Sohrab) and retell it as one continuous story.

WRITING • LEGENDS + ATLAS DECKS

Think About It essays. Every Legends and Atlas card ends with a discussion question. Have each student draw a card, take a position on its question, and defend it with one piece of evidence from the story on the card; this mirrors the Think Like a Pahlavan format in Teaching Collection Volume II. **Diary of a legend.** Students draw a character card and write a diary entry from that figure on the most important day of their life: Kaveh on the day he raised his apron, Tahmineh on the day Sohrab left home. **The hero's case.** Assign a morally complex figure (Kay Kavus, Afrasiyab, Sam, Sudabeh) and have students write a short argument for or against the title of hero, citing the card and, for research, the Encyclopedia of Legends.

MAPS & GEOGRAPHY • ATLAS OF KINGS DECK

Epic Lands Quest. Project or print the Epic Lands map. A student draws an Atlas card, classmates solve the Where Am I? clues, and the finder locates the place on the map; award a bonus point for naming a connected character or event. **Trace the journey.** Groups pick three Atlas cards and narrate one journey that truthfully connects them, such as Siavash's road from Iran across the Oxus into Turan and on to Gang Dezh. **Borders and rivers.** Using the Oxus card, discuss why rivers make natural borders, then have students find a river border on a modern map and compare.

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Vocabulary, discussion, and assessment ideas • Ages 8–12

VOCABULARY • HALL OF PERSIAN WORDS DECK

Word of the Day. Open class with one Word card: read the Persian aloud with the pronunciation guide, then challenge students to use the word once before the day ends. Pair with the Word of the Day feature on the site. **Word sorts.** Have students sort the deck into categories they defend themselves: virtues versus objects, nature versus war, things a king needs versus things a hero needs. There is no single right answer; the defense is the exercise. **Retell with three words.** Students draw three Word cards and retell any Shahnameh story using all three correctly, for example Razm, Omid, and Peyman in the story of Bijan and Manijeh. **Script practice.** Older students copy the Persian script from a card and label it with the transliteration, connecting the sound to the shape.

DISCUSSION & DEBATE • LEGENDS + WONDERS DECKS

Question circles. Deal one Legends card per student. Each reads their Think About It question aloud and gives a first answer; the circle responds before moving on. **The court of kings.** Put a figure on trial: one team prosecutes Afrasiyab, one defends him, and a student jury rules, citing cards as evidence. Repeat with Sam's abandonment of Zal or Kay Kavus's recklessness. **Wonders quiz and follow-up.** Run the Wonders questions as a class quiz, then pick one answer (the qanats, the Cyrus Cylinder, the Royal Road) and ask: what modern invention is its descendant?

ASSESSMENT & DIFFERENTIATION

Quick checks. The Who Am I? clues double as an oral quiz bank, and the three-clue point scale (3, 2, 1) is a ready-made scoring rubric. **Younger learners.** Start with the Coloring Sheets and the picture-side of Legendary cards, and use Sort the Court before any reading-heavy activity. **Advanced learners.** Send students to the Encyclopedia of Legends, Epic Bloodlines, and Timeline of Kings on the site to verify a card, extend a family tree, or find one fact the card leaves out. **Cross-curricular.** Wonders cards connect to science and world history; Word cards to language study; Atlas cards to geography; Legends cards to literature and ethics.